

Cara Qiu

Founding Growth Lead — 0-to-1 Consumer AI

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SUMMARY

Hands-on growth operator and the **first full-time growth hire** at an early-stage consumer AI startup, where I own the end-to-end **growth loop — acquisition, activation, retention, monetization, and distribution** — for products that have to be as good as mainstream tools, not just differentiated. I've taken multiple consumer AI products from **early traction to repeatable scale (0-to-1)** across the US, LatAm, and other Tier-1 markets: building channels from scratch, running the funnel myself, and coordinating external creators, freelancers, and agencies as needed. AI-native — I build my own Claude Code pipelines to move fast with a small team.

EXPERIENCE

Growth Lead (first growth hire) · PawLogic

Sep 2025 – Present

Early-stage consumer AI startup — owned the full growth loop for a new AI agent-community app and prior AI media products, as an independent hands-on operator (consultant → full-time).

- **Acquisition:** found and validated the first scalable channels — ran a Meta creative-test matrix and a Reddit → paid → Discord loop to land the first 50 users at **\$3 US CPI / 30% Day-1 retention**, spanning content, community, creators, and paid rather than paid alone.
- **Activation:** ran onboarding → paid-conversion A/B tests across bucketed traffic and landing pages to shorten time-to-first-value and lift new-user conversion per scenario.
- **Retention:** consolidated users into a Discord community as a retention/brand asset and built an automated issue-triage loop (monitoring → tiered SOP → resolution); held **30% Day-0 retention**, on track to 100K DAU.
- **Monetization:** on a prior product (Drama.Land, AI music video), set subscription/credit pricing from gross-margin analysis and scaled to **\$1M ARR in 4 months** (Google ROAS >0.6, Meta ROAS ~0.8).
- **Distribution:** built a repeatable flywheel — owned-account matrix + UGC + creator seeding + referral loops (exposure → private-link → download attribution) — driving an estimated **tens of millions of impressions**; managed external media vendors and creators throughout.
- **AI-native ops:** built an automated marketing pipeline in Claude Code / OpenClaw (competitor insight → ad angle → creative → landing page → performance review) so a small team ships faster.

Growth & Operations Lead, New Ventures · Meitu Inc.

Jun 2023 – May 2026

Publicly-listed consumer imaging & AI company (HKEX: 1357). Carried revenue targets for new AI products; 30% global strategy reporting to CPO.

- Owned the growth loop for two AI products (RoboNeo, MVLAND) as an operator carrying revenue targets, standing up a **~4-person AI-native pod per product** for fast, hands-on decisions.
- **Acquisition & distribution:** set channel mix across paid (Google, Meta), creators, community (X, LinkedIn, TikTok, Discord), and SEO — blended mega-creator reach + mid-tail UGC to **~10M impressions and ~100K DAU**; RoboNeo hit **#1 in its iOS category in 10+ countries** and #1 overall in Brazil.
- **Traction → repeatable scale:** turned first-line user research into shipped features, validated their traffic/monetization impact, and codified a stable creative playbook; MVLAND became the division's fastest-growing product (~\$500K ARR at departure), and Vmake reached ~\$500K ARR in a year on mostly organic channels.
- **Strategy:** built a company-level automated market-monitoring system (share, scenarios, competitors) informing new-bet decisions across 6 business units.

Product Manager, AI Creative-Asset System · Meitu (concurrent side project)

Dec 2025 – May 2026

Self-initiated AI system to keep growth/creative supply ahead of the market.

- Built an AI system that deconstructs winning videos and regenerates on-brand variants (four-layer semantic model + agent orchestration with gate approvals and A/B branches), taking asset production from **~2 hrs each to hourly batches, freeing ~40% of headcount** at 60 creatives/week; shipped the prototype on FastAPI / Next.js / React 19 with an 18-point QA system.

Growth/operating analytics for ad monetization & moderation; AI product for trust & safety.

- Built and led a **5-person analytics team** across ad monetization and moderation, focused on revenue and efficiency — the analytical backbone behind growth decisions.
- Led AI-product innovation for a **TikTok mental-health program** handling **sensitive user data** at scale — detection → warning → intervention → referral for **100K+ users** — with privacy and safety as first-order constraints.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

- **New Oriental** — Business Analytics Lead, K-12 online education (2019–2020): built the 0-to-1 operating-analytics stack and student/teacher segmentation; **+20% market share, +10% paid conversion**.
- **Alibaba (Ele.me)** — Business Analysis Manager (2019): national merchant strategy — penetration, budget allocation, and SMB/KA acquisition playbooks.
- **Didi** — Regional Operations Manager, Melbourne / Tokyo / Latin America (2017–2018): overseas ops; drove driver-side supply to **30% penetration** in the Australia launch.
- **Accenture** — Senior Business Analyst (2013–2016): digital-transformation strategy for large enterprises.

SELECTED SIDE PROJECT

- **LocalAd Studio** — solo-built growth/creative agent for US blue-collar services (plumbing, HVAC, cleaning, moving): deconstruct winning local ads → swap slots (city/service/season) → storyboard/copy → render, on Claude Code / FastAPI / Next.js. Lifted output from **8/day to hourly batches (~80% less manual effort)**. (2026)

SKILLS

Growth Loop: acquisition (content · SEO · community · partnerships · creator ecosystem · paid) · activation (onboarding · Aha-moment · A/B) · retention (behavioral analysis · LTV · community) · monetization (paid conversion · margin-based pricing) · distribution (referral · UGC flywheel · owned-account matrix)

Operating style: 0-to-1 / founding growth · hands-on independent operator · early-traction → repeatable scale · vendor / freelancer / agency coordination · cross-border markets (US · LatAm)

AI & Tooling: Claude Code · OpenClaw · AI growth pipelines / workflow automation · ML user segmentation (random forest) · FastAPI / Next.js prototyping

Languages: Mandarin (native) · English (fluent, working proficiency) · Spanish (learning)

EDUCATION

University of Melbourne — M.S., Information Systems (minor: Finance)	2010–2012
Huazhong University of Science & Technology — B.E., Electronic & Information Engineering	2006–2010